

Chapter 3 Test Answers

TR 3.10A

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

1. Choose all that describe how Jesus affirms Old Testament authority.
 - a. assuming Scripture is final in authority
 - b. giving a sermon on why people should read the Old Testament
 - c. treating the miraculous events in the Old Testament as historical events
 - d. explaining why copying errors in the Old Testament manuscripts don't matter
 - e. leaning on the Old Testament when he was in personal spiritual anguish
2. What does internal evidence indicate the biblical writers believed they were doing?
 - a. They wanted to just offer good advice for living.
 - b. They wanted to tell some good stories.
 - c. They claimed they were communicating God's authoritative revelation.
 - d. They claimed they were sharing new and personal insights about God.
3. What are some good reasons to trust the Gospels?
 - a. The Gospels were written by eyewitnesses.
 - b. The church fathers affirmed the teachings of the New Testament.
 - c. The Gospels were written early enough to be affirmed or denied by living eyewitnesses and those who had heard the gospel from eyewitnesses.
 - d. None of the above
4. What is a textual variant?
 - a. illustrations added on the margins of ancient manuscripts to explain doctrine
 - b. differences between particular words, phrases, or passages within multiple copies of the same ancient manuscript
 - c. evidence of corruption in ancient manuscripts since all variants affect meaning
 - d. differences that indicate the person copying the manuscripts added their own interpretation and subtle changes to direct the reader's beliefs
5. Which group of people wrote letters and documents that carefully mirrored the New Testament?
 - a. the church fathers
 - b. the apostles
 - c. the disciples
 - d. the gnostics

6. Choose all that accurately describe gnosticism.
 - a. taught that the world was created by a lesser divine being
 - b. taught that the body and the material world are intrinsically evil
 - c. taught that Jesus was an angel who became a human to bring God's message
 - d. sometimes taught that Jesus was merely a spirit who appeared to be human
 - e. sometimes taught that people could become transcendent spirits like Jesus
 - f. taught the same things that the Gospels taught and that early Christians believed
 - g. taught that salvation can be obtained only through self-denial and esoteric knowledge of divine reality
7. Radical individualism expresses the idea that . . .
 - a. I am an individual created in the image of God.
 - b. I should be a loner and avoid groupthink.
 - c. no one has the right to tell me what to do.
 - d. no one should be too dependent on others.
8. Which of the following are examples of archaeological evidence for the reliability of the Old Testament?
 - a. the unearthing of Solomon's building projects
 - b. the fulfillment of prophecies by Jesus
 - c. the discovery of Hezekiah's tunnel
 - d. the assassination of Sennacherib by his sons
9. How far does God's authority extend?
 - a. God has authority over most areas of life.
 - b. God has authority over private religious life and church activities.
 - c. God has authority over creation and over the people who believe in him.
 - d. God has authority over all areas of life, whether people acknowledge it or not.
10. Which unearthed documents confirmed the accurate copying of the Old Testament?
 - a. writings of the early church fathers
 - b. Dead Sea Scrolls
 - c. Lost gospels
 - d. Masoretic manuscripts
11. God wants people to obey him because . . .
 - a. he wants to spoil our fun.
 - b. he knows that obedience to him leads to human flourishing.
 - c. he wants to control us.
 - d. he doesn't care if people obey him or not.

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True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

F 12. The Dead Sea Scrolls contained a scroll of Jeremiah that was nearly one thousand years older than the next oldest copy available at the time. Isaiah

F 13. Some of the church fathers studied directly under Jesus, so their writings confirm the authenticity of the Gospels. the apostles

T 14. The New Testament books were passed along by the written word and distributed widely throughout the early church, making it possible to accurately reconstruct the originals from the early manuscripts that survived. _____

F 15. Historical details included in the book of Acts can be confirmed through fulfilled prophecies. archaeological evidence

T 16. We have over 25,000 early New Testament manuscripts and fragments from five different document families from ancient Christian communities. _____

F 17. Scholars find 99.5 percent disagreement between early New Testament manuscripts with variations mainly in spelling, grammar, word order, and minor deletions or additions—none of which affect major doctrines. agreement

F 18. God's standards of right and wrong are true only for the cultures that practice them. true for all cultures at all times

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

19. The four non-Christian writings that confirm historical facts about Jesus' life and the beliefs of early Christians include the Talmud, and the writings of Tacitus, Josephus, and Pliny the Younger.

20. For Christians, the lines of authority are clear. To say "Jesus is Lord," is



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to believe what Jesus taught and obey his teaching.

21. In 2 Peter 3:15–16, the apostle Peter said the apostle Paul's letters had the authority of Scripture.
22. The lost gospels are gnostic texts written sometime between ad 200 and 400.
23. It's not spelling errors, but textual variants that affect the meaning of the text that matter.
24. Gnosticism is a heresy that affected the early church and that taught the material world was inherently evil.
25. God has authority over culture, government, knowledge, emotions, and entertainment.
26. Some scholars identify more than 55 prophecies that Jesus fulfilled relating to his birth, ministry, death, resurrection, and role in the church.
27. Everyone, including Christians, should ask questions about the Bible and its authority with a spirit of humility and genuine openness to learning, rather than blindly accepting the claims of skeptics.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

28. Explain what it means for a Christian to be under God's authority.
To be under God's authority means that you believe in the teachings in the Bible and that you obey and submit to Jesus Christ.
29. What are the three main types of external evidence for the reliability of the Old Testament? ancient nonbiblical historical texts, fulfilled prophecy, archaeological discoveries
30. How would you explain to a skeptic why the lost gospels were not included in the Bible?
Answers should include the three tests for inclusion of books in the biblical canon: apostolicity (written by an apostle), orthodoxy (consistent with the rest of the New Testament), and pedigree (widely accepted by the early church). Answers should also mention that the lost gospels don't pass all those tests.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

31. Is the number of textual variants in the early New Testament manuscripts (over 400,000) a problem for the reliability of the New Testament? Why or why not?
No, the number of textual variants is not a problem. We have such a large number of early New Testament manuscripts that survived that we can reconstruct the originals. We can see how widely they were distributed during the earliest centuries of Christianity. This gives us good reason to trust the manuscripts. Also, the vast majority of textual variants are spelling, word order, or other minor errors that do not affect the meaning. The errors or additions and subtractions that affect the meaning do not affect core doctrines.
32. Using what you have learned, give three reasons why the authority of the Bible can be trusted. Answers should include three of the following:
External evidence confirms the historical reliability of the Scripture. This includes evidence from ancient historical sources, archaeological discoveries, and fulfilled Old Testament prophecies. The Dead Sea Scrolls and 25,000 New Testament manuscripts and fragments confirm the reliability and accuracy of the Scriptures. The eyewitness testimonies of the New Testament writers give credibility to their writings. Early church fathers and ancient non-Christian sources like Tacitus, the Talmud, Pliny the Younger, and Josephus also confirm that the New Testament can be trusted. Jesus fulfilled many Old Testament prophecies about his birth, life, death, and role in the church.
33. Is trust in God's authority blind? Why or why not? Create and include an analogy that supports your answer.
No, trust in God's authority is based on evidence of the reliability of the Old and New Testaments. Analogies will vary. Possible answers: trusting a parachute will open because the technology has been tested, trusting a chair won't break since it has proved to be reliable when sat or stood on, trusting that electricity will make a lightbulb glow when turned on.